

MISSION STATEMENT

*Because forest fires pose an ever-increasing threat to lives, property and biodiversity, have a significant impact on recreation and commerce, and have an ever higher public visibility (largely because of the ability to transmit television images from nearly anywhere in real time), the **USFS needs a more effective system to identify and monitor them.** In addition, it would be desired (but not required) to monitor forest fires for other nations; **collect statistical data on fire outbreaks, spread, speed and duration, and provide other forest management data.** This must be done at **low cost** to make the **system affordable to the Forest Service** and **not give the perception of wasting money** that could be better spent on fire-fighting equipment or personnel.*

*Ultimately, the Forest Service's fire monitoring office, fire management officers in the field, and **individual firefighters and rangers fighting the fire will use the data.** Data flow and formats must meet the needs of all the groups without specialized training and must allow them to respond promptly and efficiently to changing conditions.*

(adapted from "Space Mission Engineering: the new SMAD, 2011")